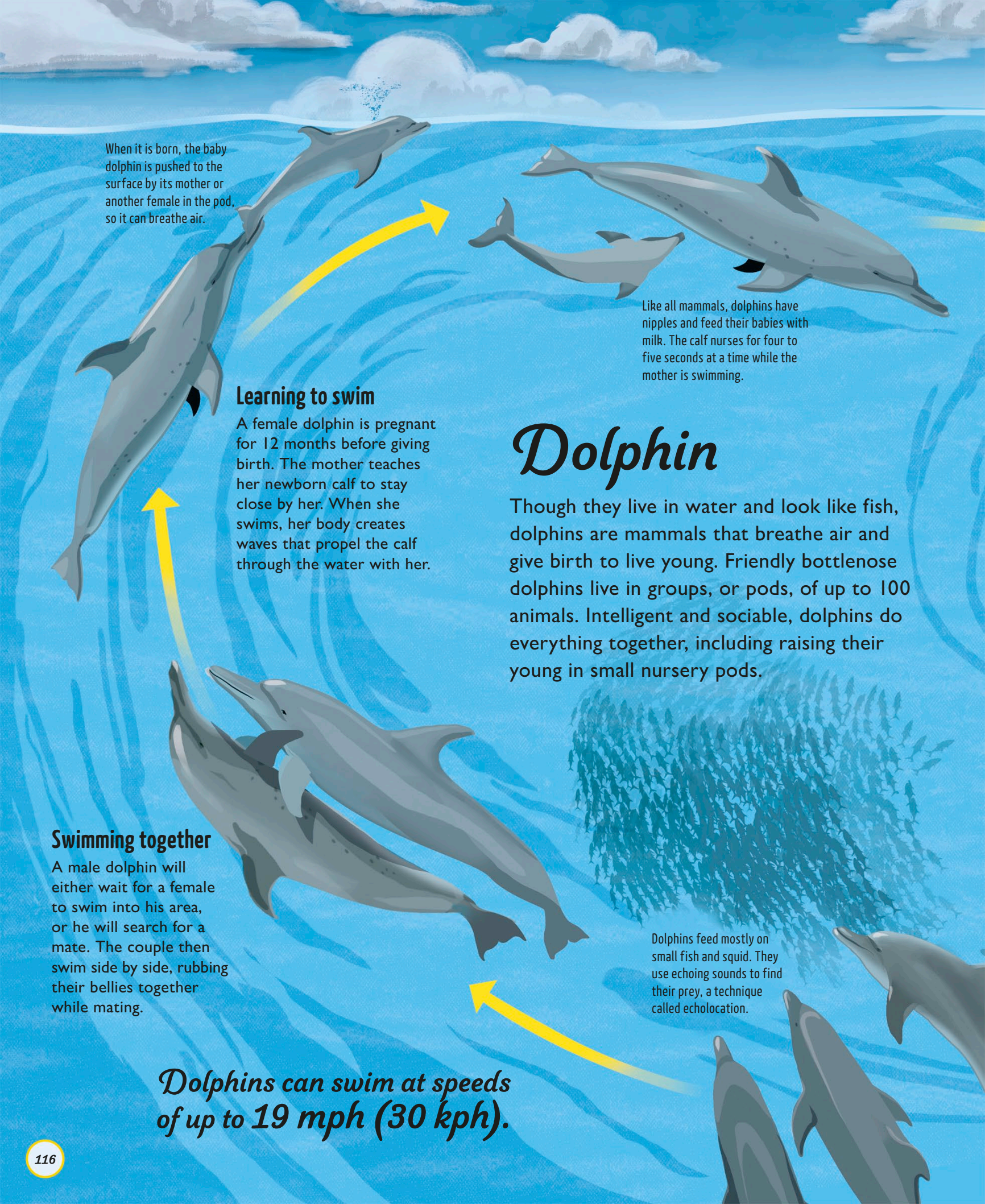




When it is born, the baby dolphin is pushed to the surface by its mother or another female in the pod, so it can breathe air.

Learning to swim

A female dolphin is pregnant for 12 months before giving birth. The mother teaches her newborn calf to stay close by her. When she swims, her body creates waves that propel the calf through the water with her.

Like all mammals, dolphins have nipples and feed their babies with milk. The calf nurses for four to five seconds at a time while the mother is swimming.

Dolphin

Though they live in water and look like fish, dolphins are mammals that breathe air and give birth to live young. Friendly bottlenose dolphins live in groups, or pods, of up to 100 animals. Intelligent and sociable, dolphins do everything together, including raising their young in small nursery pods.

Swimming together

A male dolphin will either wait for a female to swim into his area, or he will search for a mate. The couple then swim side by side, rubbing their bellies together while mating.

Dolphins feed mostly on small fish and squid. They use echoing sounds to find their prey, a technique called echolocation.

Dolphins can swim at speeds of up to 19 mph (30 kph).